

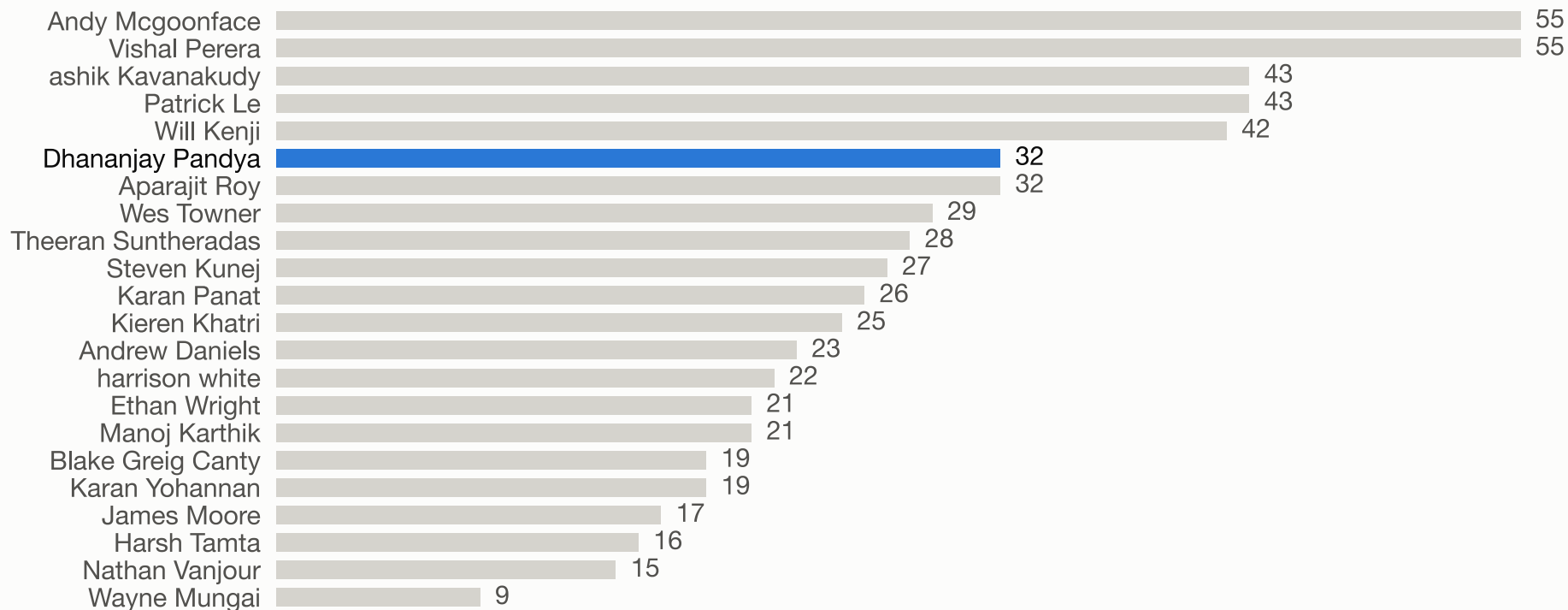


GAMEWEEK 1 · BUY-IN BALLER LEAGUE

# How your team stacks up

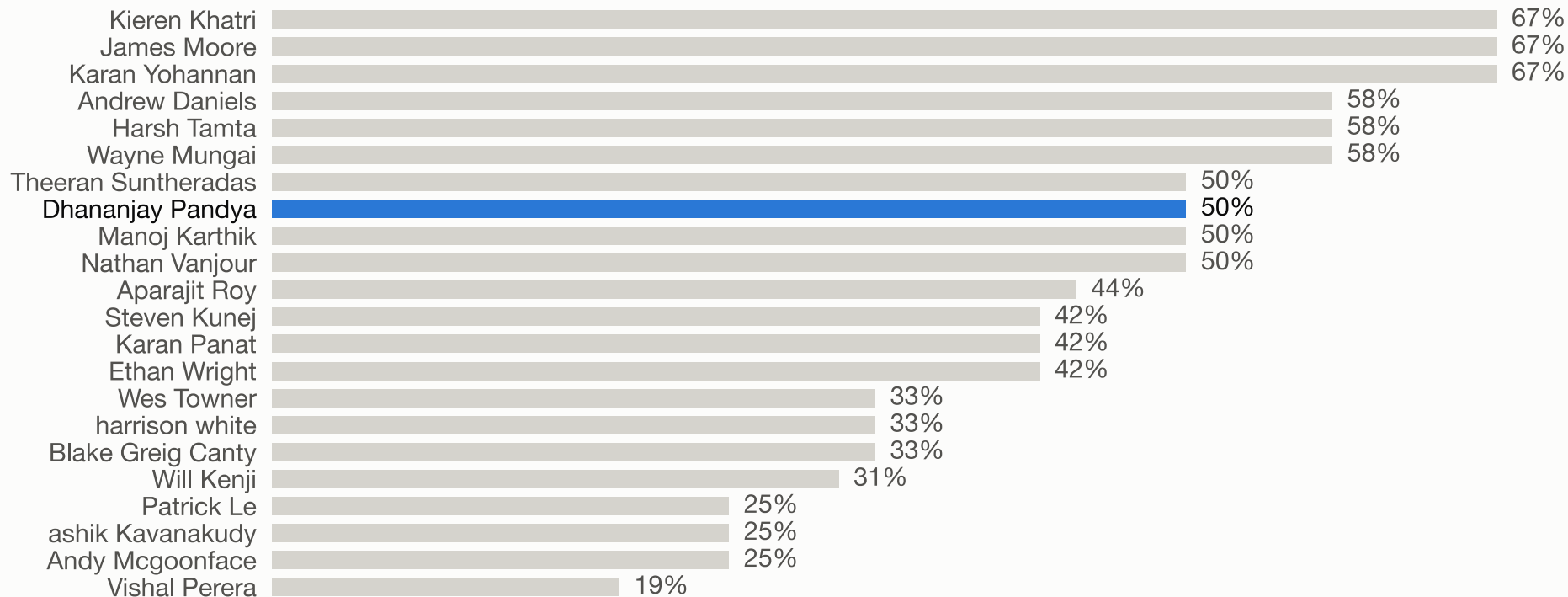
Dhananjay Pandya · 22 managers. Read the titles alone and you have the whole story. The appendix holds the detail.

## You sit 6th of 22, 23 points behind the leaders



Points so far in Gameweek 1

# Half your points are still to come, and the leaders have almost none left

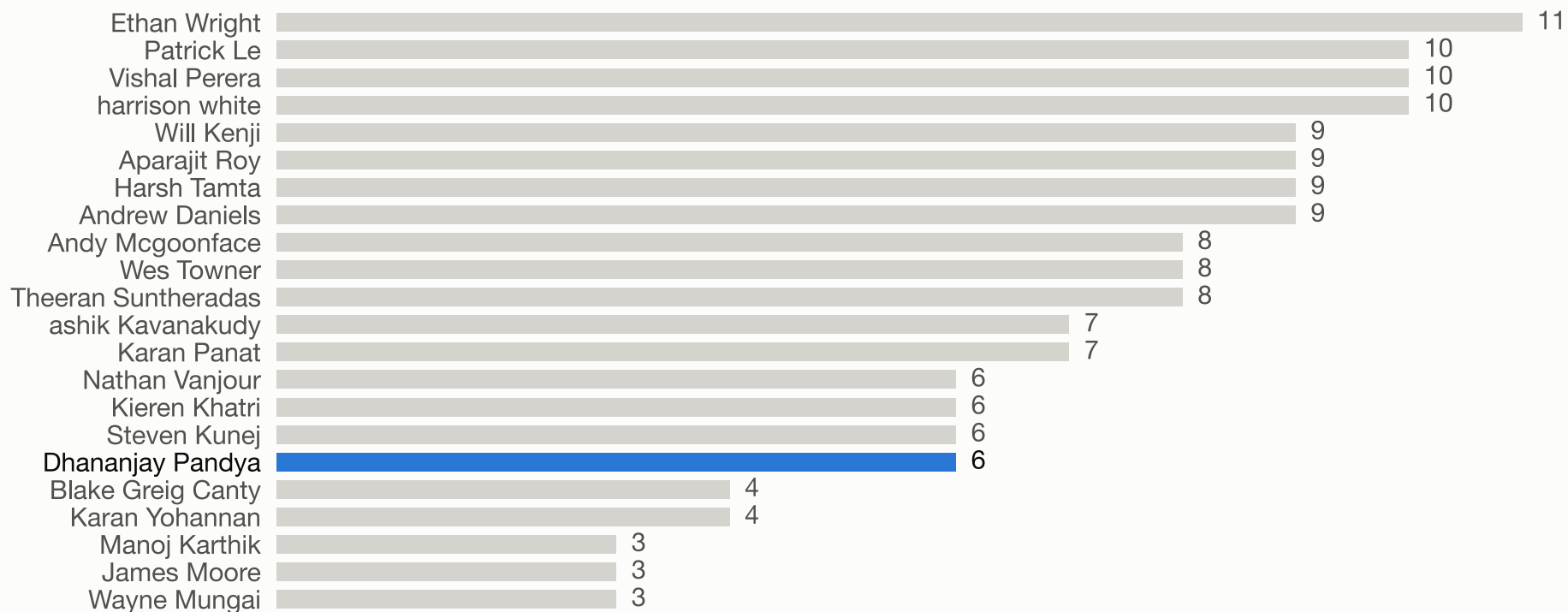


Share of your score still to be played

# Every player the leader has left is also in your team

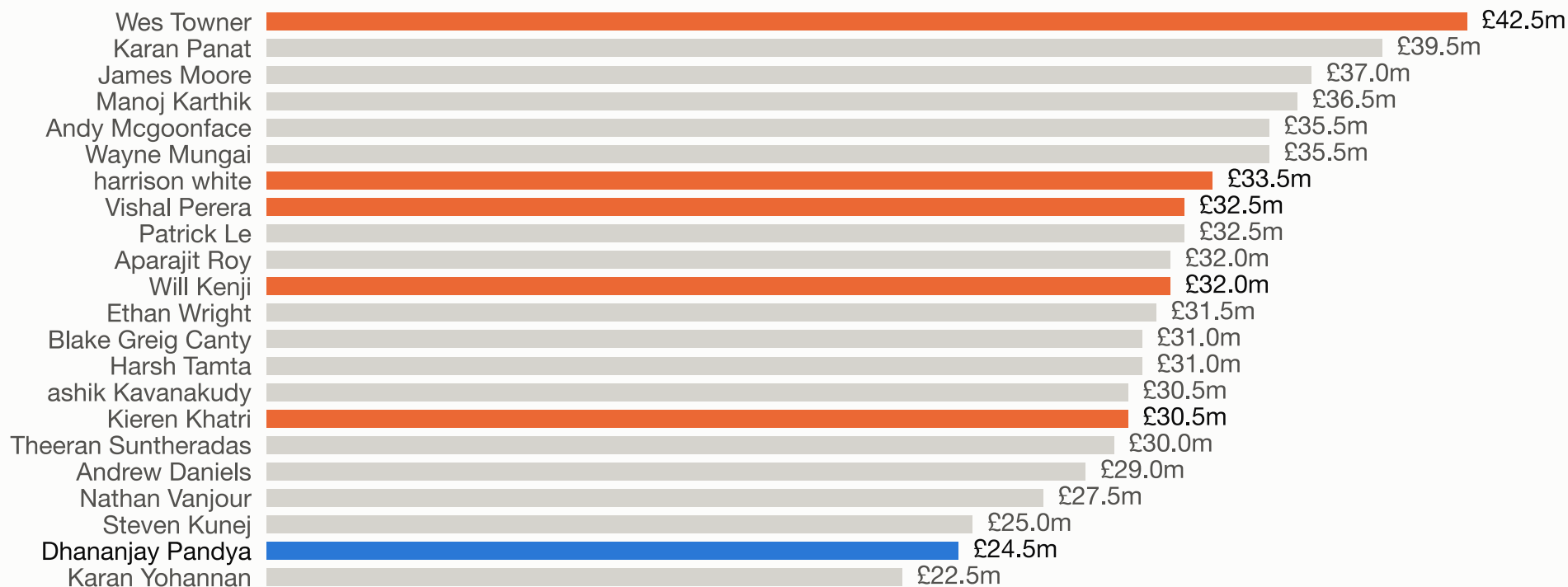
|            | You | Andy Mcgoonface |                                |
|------------|-----|-----------------|--------------------------------|
| Haaland    | 2x  |                 | 2x = captain,<br>scores double |
| Groß       |     |                 |                                |
| João Pedro |     |                 |                                |
| Szoboszlai |     |                 |                                |
| Virgil     |     |                 |                                |

## You own only 6 of the league's 15 most-popular players



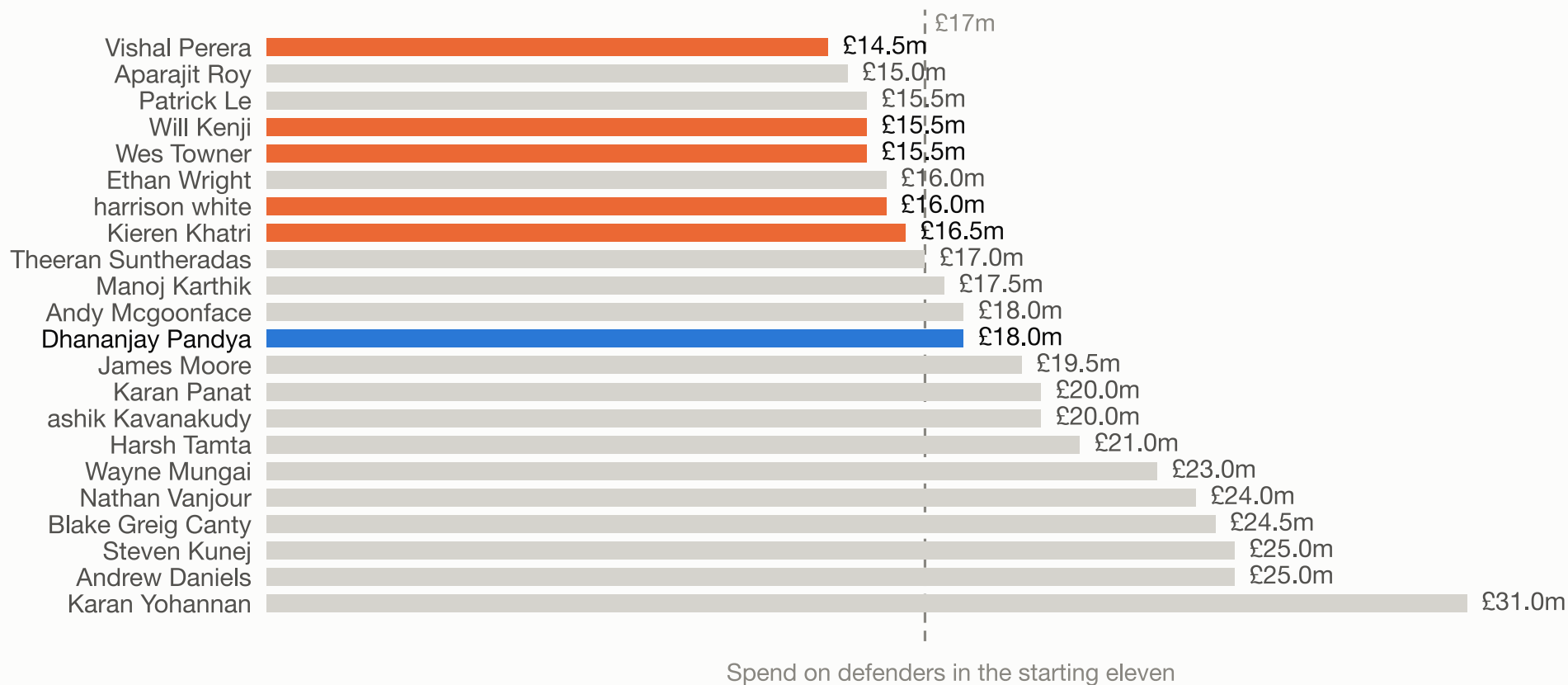
How many of the league's 15 most-owned players each manager holds

## You spend the second-least on midfield in the whole league



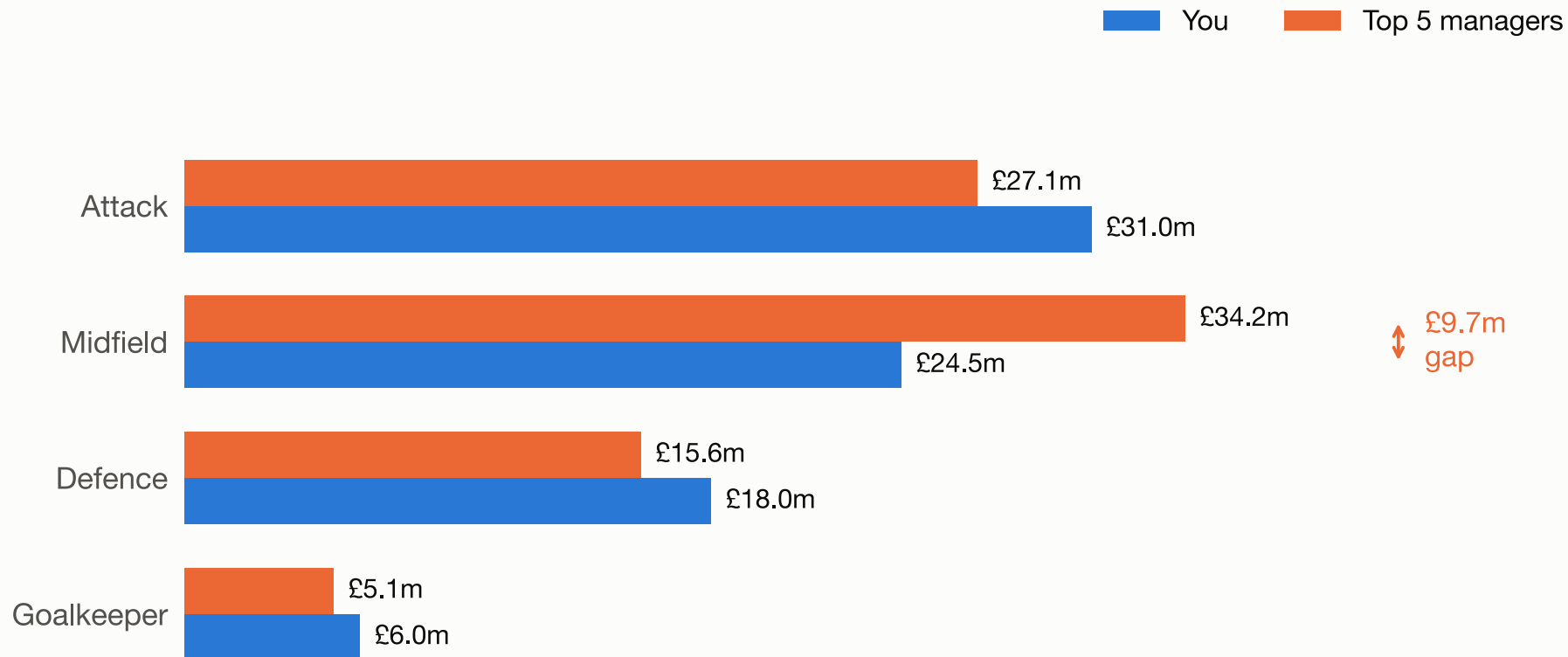
Spend on midfielders in the starting eleven

## The five most consistent managers all keep defence under £17m

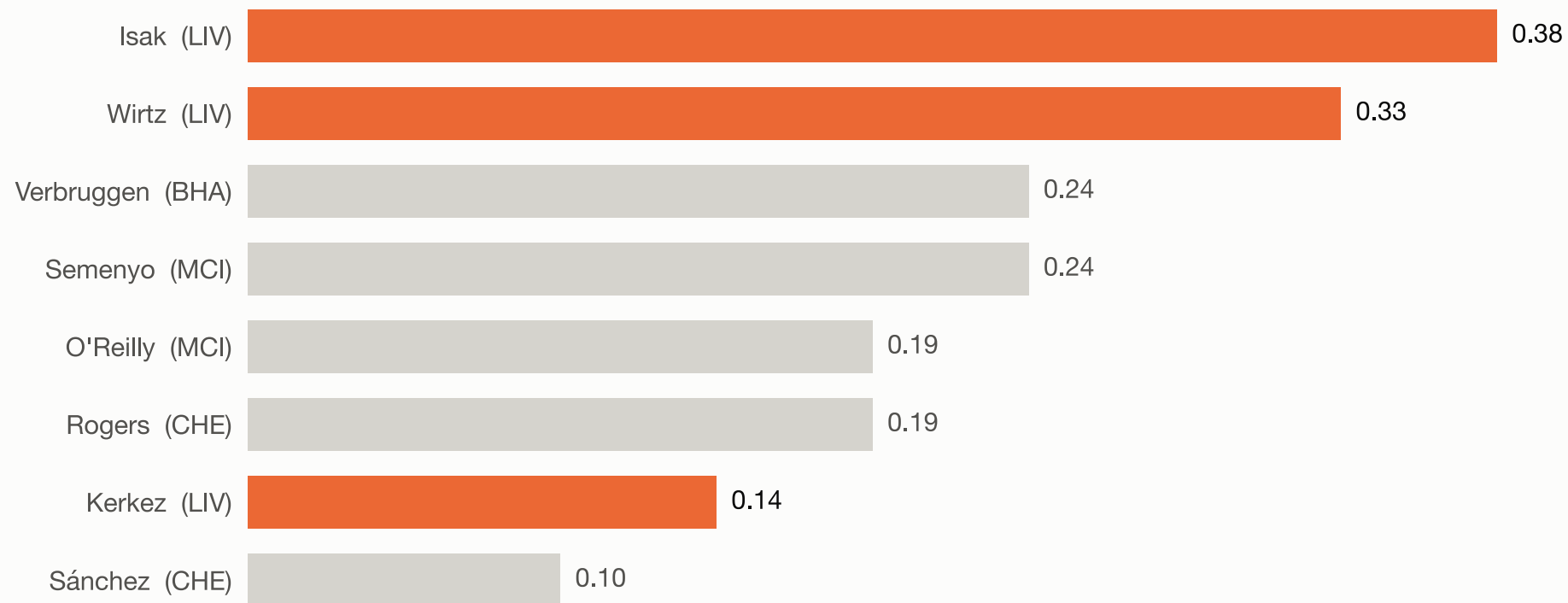


Gameweek 1, 6 of 10 matches played. Scores are not final. Orange marks those five managers.

# Those managers put £10m more than you into midfield



## Your two biggest remaining risks both play for Liverpool



Ground you lose for every point this player scores

# Appendix

## Where you stand

You are 6th of 22 managers with 32 points. The leaders have 55. That gap looks bad, but it hides something important. Only six of the ten matches have been played. Four have not started yet.

**Half of your score is still to come.** You have six scoring units left. The two leaders have three each. A scoring unit is one player, counted twice if you captained him.

Against Andy Mcgoonface, one of the two leaders, you cannot fall further behind. Every player he has left, you also own. You captain Haaland and he does not, so Haaland earns you double what he earns him. Only a red card could change that.

## The template team

The template is the group of players most managers own. When you own them, you move with the crowd. When you do not, you win or lose ground quickly. You own 6 of the 15. That puts you joint 14th of 22 for template coverage, so you are one of the more contrarian managers in this league.

| Player      | Position | Club | Owned by | Counting captains | You own? |
|-------------|----------|------|----------|-------------------|----------|
| Raya        | GKP      | ARS  | 41%      | 41%               | Yes      |
| Kinsky      | GKP      | TOT  | 36%      | 27%               | Yes      |
| Calafiori   | DEF      | ARS  | 59%      | 59%               | Yes      |
| Gabriel     | DEF      | ARS  | 41%      | 41%               | No       |
| Shaw        | DEF      | MUN  | 41%      | 32%               | No       |
| Diop        | DEF      | IPS  | 32%      | 9%                | No       |
| Maguire     | DEF      | MUN  | 32%      | 27%               | No       |
| B.Fernandes | MID      | MUN  | 64%      | 86%               | No       |

| Player        | Position | Club | Owned by | Counting captains | You own? |
|---------------|----------|------|----------|-------------------|----------|
| Groß          | MID      | BHA  | 50%      | 32%               | Yes      |
| Mbeumo        | MID      | MUN  | 41%      | 41%               | No       |
| Tzolis        | MID      | ARS  | 41%      | 41%               | No       |
| Wirtz         | MID      | LIV  | 32%      | 32%               | No       |
| Haaland       | FWD      | MCI  | 77%      | 141%              | Yes      |
| João Pedro    | FWD      | CHE  | 73%      | 68%               | Yes      |
| Calvert-Lewin | FWD      | LEE  | 50%      | 36%               | No       |

Three players are yours alone in this league. Nobody else owns Vuskovic, Ampadu or Mitchell.

## How everyone spends their money

This is the money each manager put into their starting eleven, split by position. Three managers played Bench Boost, so I measured everyone on the same eleven slots to keep it fair.

| #  | Manager             | Points | Still to play | Defence | Midfield | Attack |
|----|---------------------|--------|---------------|---------|----------|--------|
| 1  | Andy Mcgoonface     | 55     | 25%           | £18.0m  | £35.5m   | £23.0m |
| 1  | Vishal Perera       | 55     | 19%           | £14.5m  | £32.5m   | £29.0m |
| 3  | ashik Kavanakudy    | 43     | 25%           | £20.0m  | £30.5m   | £21.5m |
| 3  | Patrick Le          | 43     | 25%           | £15.5m  | £32.5m   | £29.0m |
| 5  | Will Kenji          | 42     | 31%           | £15.5m  | £32.0m   | £29.0m |
| 6  | Dhananjay Pandya    | 32     | 50%           | £18.0m  | £24.5m   | £31.0m |
| 6  | Aparajit Roy        | 32     | 44%           | £15.0m  | £32.0m   | £29.0m |
| 8  | Wes Towner          | 29     | 33%           | £15.5m  | £42.5m   | £16.5m |
| 9  | Theeran Suntheradas | 28     | 50%           | £17.0m  | £30.0m   | £30.0m |
| 10 | Steven Kunej        | 27     | 42%           | £25.0m  | £25.0m   | £27.0m |
| 11 | Karan Panat         | 26     | 42%           | £20.0m  | £39.5m   | £16.5m |
| 12 | Kieren Khatri       | 25     | 67%           | £16.5m  | £30.5m   | £32.0m |
| 13 | Andrew Daniels      | 23     | 58%           | £25.0m  | £29.0m   | £23.0m |

| #  | Manager           | Points | Still to play | Defence | Midfield | Attack |
|----|-------------------|--------|---------------|---------|----------|--------|
| 14 | harrison white    | 22     | 33%           | £16.0m  | £33.5m   | £29.0m |
| 15 | Ethan Wright      | 21     | 42%           | £16.0m  | £31.5m   | £29.0m |
| 15 | Manoj Karthik     | 21     | 50%           | £17.5m  | £36.5m   | £17.0m |
| 17 | Blake Greig Canty | 19     | 33%           | £24.5m  | £31.0m   | £21.5m |
| 17 | Karan Yohannan    | 19     | 67%           | £31.0m  | £22.5m   | £23.0m |
| 19 | James Moore       | 17     | 67%           | £19.5m  | £37.0m   | £16.5m |
| 20 | Harsh Tamta       | 16     | 58%           | £21.0m  | £31.0m   | £23.0m |
| 21 | Nathan Vanjour    | 15     | 50%           | £24.0m  | £27.5m   | £21.5m |
| 22 | Wayne Mungai      | 9      | 58%           | £23.0m  | £35.5m   | £14.0m |

You spend **£24.5m on midfield**, the second-lowest in the league. You spend **£31.0m on attack**, the second-highest. That is Haaland. He costs £15.5m, which is half your attack budget, and paying for him is why your midfield is thin.

### What the best managers do

I ranked every manager by their median finish over the last five seasons. I used the median because it rewards being good every year, not one lucky season. Kieren Khatri comes third, which matches the example you gave me, so the measure is picking up the right thing.

| # | Manager          | Median finish | Last five seasons                                            |
|---|------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Will Kenji       | 151,489       | 21/22:73k; 22/23:77k; 23/24:509k; 24/25:151k; 25/26:204k     |
| 2 | harrison white   | 151,736       | 21/22:369k; 22/23:151k; 23/24:47k; 24/25:41k; 25/26:452k     |
| 3 | Kieren Khatri    | 192,647       | 21/22:1009k; 22/23:192k; 23/24:316k; 24/25:167k; 25/26:83k   |
| 4 | Wes Towner       | 343,588       | 21/22:5648k; 22/23:2065k; 23/24:343k; 24/25:284k; 25/26:332k |
| 5 | Vishal Perera    | 360,721       | 21/22:539k; 22/23:532k; 23/24:116k; 24/25:360k; 25/26:261k   |
| 6 | Dhananjay Pandya | 457,742       | 21/22:104k; 22/23:502k; 23/24:49k; 24/25:804k; 25/26:457k    |

You sit sixth. Your best season was a 49k finish, so your ceiling is not the problem. Your results simply swing a lot from year to year.

One habit stands out. **All five of the best managers keep defence between £14.5m and £16.5m**. Every single one. The rest of the league averages £20.8m. They then pour that money into midfield, between £30.5m and £42.5m. You spend £18.0m on defence and £24.5m on midfield. That is a £9.7m

midfield gap against the people who win most often.

Five players show up in three or more of their teams that you do not own: Bruno Fernandes, Mbeumo, Wirtz, Schade and Calvert-Lewin. Four of those five play in midfield.

**Be careful with this.** This is one gameweek. I tested whether spending more on any position actually links to more points so far, and nothing is solid yet. Every result could easily be chance, and the biggest attackers have not played. Check this again after ten weeks. That is when a pattern would mean something.

## Your biggest risks

A player hurts you when your rivals own him and you do not. I measured it by asking a simple question: for every point this player scores, how much ground do I lose to the average rival?

Your largest threat already passed. **Bruno Fernandes returned 2 points.** He was owned by 64% of the league and captained by five managers. He blanked. That was a big win for you and you did not have to do anything.

These players have not kicked a ball yet, so they are the live danger.

| Player     | Club | Cost to you per point |
|------------|------|-----------------------|
| Isak       | LIV  | 0.38                  |
| Wirtz      | LIV  | 0.33                  |
| Verbruggen | BHA  | 0.24                  |
| Semenyo    | MCI  | 0.24                  |
| O'Reilly   | MCI  | 0.19                  |
| Rogers     | CHE  | 0.19                  |
| Kerkez     | LIV  | 0.14                  |
| Sánchez    | CHE  | 0.10                  |

Three of your top seven threats play for Liverpool, in the same match against Newcastle. You own none of them. You do own Virgil van Dijk and Szoboszlai, so a Liverpool clean sheet still pays you.

Two thirds of the league captained Haaland, including you. That means a big Haaland score *protects* you more than it promotes you. You keep pace with most of the league, but you do not gain. Your gains have to come from your other players.

## What to do next

Do not change anything because of one gameweek. Instead, watch one number. The best managers in your league put about £34m into midfield and keep defence near £15m. You are at £24.5m and £18.0m. Track that gap over the next few weeks. If the pattern holds once real data builds up, moving money from defence into midfield is the single change most likely to move you up.

## Where the numbers come from

Everything here comes from the official Fantasy Premier League API, pulled live during Gameweek 1 with six of ten matches played and none finalised. Bonus points and scores can still change. You can rebuild every number by running `scripts/league_report.py` and then `scripts/league_story.py`.